

Single Source Justification (Simplified Acquisition)

Section A: General Contract Information

Is this a Bridge Action as defined in the [AF Bridge Action Reduction Plan](#)? ☐ Yes ☒ No

Contracting Activity: AFLCMC/PZIBB

Project/Program Name: Road Weather Information System (RWIS)

Purchase Request / Local ID Number: [REDACTED]

Estimated Contract Cost (including Options): [REDACTED]

Section B: Description of the Supplies/Services Required

The Road Weather Information System (RWIS) at Wright-Patterson Air Force Base (WPAFB) consists of proprietary equipment and software. Through a series of atmospheric sensors and sensors buried in the runway pavement, data is collected by Remote Processing Units (RPUs) and then transmitted over radio to a Central Processing Unit (CPU). The information provided by the CPU displays surface temperature and indicates whether the runways are dry or wet and the presence of chemicals or ice. The CPU converts the data into displayable tables, charts, and maps and transmits it back the Government. The hardware/software for this system is licensed by Vaisala Inc.

There are currently seven (7) sensors located at WPAFB. These sensors collect the runway surface condition information that is relayed back to two (2) RPU sites located on the airfield. Each RPU site house contains one motherboard, which collects sensor readings and transmits real-time data to the main CPU server located in England, and then back to the 88 Operations Support Squadron (OSS). One (1) of the (2) two RPUs was placed under contract to be upgraded by Vaisala Inc. in 2025.

The agency requires installation of an additional two (2) in-ground pavement sensors and one (1) in-ground subgrade sensor into runway locations coordinated with 88 OSS personnel. The agency also requires upgrade of the second RPU from LX to RWS200 hardware re-utilizing the currently installed infrastructure as much as possible. The second RPU has exceeded its expected end of life.

Section C: Justification for Soliciting from a Single Source or Brand Name

The current contract, FA860125P0173, was awarded to Vaisala Inc. with a single source justification due to only one company holding the proprietary rights to the hardware/software currently used by the Government. Vaisala Inc. is the only company authorized to calibrate, maintain, and execute necessary adjustments to the system for proper operation. The current contract includes a base year (nine months) and four (4) option years of data management and preventative maintenance services and the upgrade of one (1) RPU.

In accordance with (IAW) RFO 6.103-1(c)(2), awarding a new contract for the continued provision of these highly specialized products and services would result in (i) substantial duplication of cost to the Government that is not expected to be recovered through competition; and (ii) unacceptable delays in fulfilling the agency's requirements.

Awarding to a source other than Vaisala Inc. would result in substantial duplication of costs. The

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Government would need to either purchase licensing rights from Vaisala Inc. to compete the requirements amongst suitable companies or procure and install a new RWIS that includes open market hardware/software elements as proprietary rights to the existing system are currently owned by Vaisala Inc. Both of these alternatives would result in redundant cost to the Government.

Vaisala Inc. is already under contract to upgrade one (1) of the two (2) RPU's. Awarding to a source other than Vaisala Inc. would result in unnecessary delays in fulfilling the agency's requirements as a competition would need to be run to select a new company. Additionally, the new company would need to familiarize itself with the existing hardware/software prior to installing the sensors and upgrading the RPU's, which is a task that only possible with access to the Vaisala Inc. proprietary hardware/software. Or alternatively, the new company would need to replace the current system with an entirely new open hardware/software RWIS, which would result in a significant and needless delay in fulfilling the Government's requirements.

Finally, awarding a contract to procure the three (3) additional sensors and one (1) RPU upgrade to a company other than Vaisala Inc. would result in compatibility and integration issues with the existing system. Awarding to a source other than Vaisala Inc. is not in the Government's best interest because of all the reasons outlined above.

Section D: Efforts to Obtain Competition

Market research via Internet searches was conducted to identify other companies able to offer products and services similar to the existing RWIS at WPAFB. However, because of the proprietary hardware and software currently used at WPAFB, no other companies are able to meet the Government's requirement except Vaisala Inc.

Section E: Steps to Preclude Future Single Source or Brand Name Awards

In order to move away from a single source award for the proprietary hardware and software linked to the atmospheric sensors and sensors buried in the runway pavement at WPAFB, the Air Force and WPAFB would need to consider purchasing a new RWIS that includes open market hardware/software elements. This would eliminate proprietary rights and the need for a single source.

If that is not an option due to cost or other constraints, the Government could pursue purchasing licensing rights from Vaisala Inc. or enter into discussions with that company to establish an authorized maintenance distribution network in order for the Government to compete upgrade and maintenance requirements amongst authorized distributors. Regardless, the tie back to Vaisala Inc. will remain intact as long as that company holds the proprietary rights to the hardware/software currently used by the Government.

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Section F: Contracting Officer's Determination

I have determined, in accordance with [FAR 13.106-1\(b\)\(1\)](#), that the circumstances of this contract action deem only a single source is reasonably available.

Date	Typed Name and Rank/Grade of Contracting Officer	Signature of Contracting Officer
04-May-2026		